C O N C E N T R I C

S E C U R I T Y G R O U P

LEO Ground Station Market

Opportunity Assessment

Operators | Ownership | Infrastructure | Traffic | Projections

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Satellite Imagery: Copernicus Sentinel-2 (separate annex available)

1. Market Overview

The LEO satellite ground station market is undergoing structural expansion. Multiple broadband constellations are scaling simultaneously, Ground Station as a Service (GSaaS) has emerged as the dominant delivery model, and regulatory requirements force in-country ground infrastructure for every market a constellation operator enters. This document maps the full operator landscape, identifies where the next stations will be built, estimates traffic volumes, and flags the most difficult deployment environments.

Metric	2025/26	2030 (Projected)
Total Ground Station Market	$41.0B	$82.7B (15.1% CAGR)
LEO GSaaS Sub-Market	$1.72B (2024)	$5.33B by 2033 (14.2% CAGR)
Active LEO Satellites	15,000+	25,000+
Starlink Subscribers	10M+ (Feb 2026)	14M (est)
Ground Stations Required	~500 (all operators)	1,000+
Sites in This Register	129	

2. LEO Constellation Operators

Seven LEO broadband constellations are either operational, launching, or in funded development. Ownership structures range from wholly-owned subsidiaries of US tech giants to Chinese state enterprises and EU multi-national consortia. Architecture choices — particularly whether the constellation uses a transparent (ground-dependent) or regenerative (ISL-enabled) design — directly determine ground station density requirements.

Constellation	HQ Nation	Ownership	Satellites	Ground Stns	Architecture	Status (Mar 2026)
Starlink	USA	SpaceX (private). Elon Musk controlling shareholder.	9,400+	170+	Regenerative + ISL	Operational. 10M subs. 150 countries. E-band expansion.
Amazon Leo (Kuiper)	USA	Amazon subsidiary (NASDAQ: AMZN). Jeff Bezos executive chairman.	212	12 + 300 planned	Regenerative + OISL	Deploying. FCC deadline Jul 2026. Beta programme.
Eutelsat OneWeb	UK / France	Eutelsat Group (Euronext: ETL). Bharti Global (India), UK Govt minority stakes.	648	~45	Transparent (bent-pipe)	Operational. Global coverage. Gen 2 planned.
Telesat Lightspeed	Canada	Telesat Corp (NASDAQ: TSAT). Loral Space & Comms + PSP Investments (Canadian pension).	0	3 planned	Regenerative	SpaceX launches from mid-2026. Seeking GS partners.
IRIS²	EU (Belgium)	EU consortium. Eutelsat (prime), SES (Luxembourg), Hispasat (Spain). EU-funded.	0	TBD	Multi-orbit	First launch 2029. €6B budget.
Guowang	China	China SatNet (state enterprise). PRC sovereign constellation.	0	TBD	Regenerative	12,992 sats planned. Initial launches 2026.
Qianfan (G60)	China	Shanghai Spacecom Satellite Tech. Shanghai municipal + private.	18	TBD	Regenerative	14,000 sats planned. 18 launched to date.

Key Ownership Observations

- Western LEO broadband is dominated by two American billionaire-controlled entities (SpaceX/Musk and Amazon/Bezos) competing directly. Neither is publicly traded at the operating entity level, limiting transparency.
- OneWeb’s ownership is a UK-India-France structure reflecting its bankruptcy rescue: Bharti Global (Indian), the UK Government, and now Eutelsat (French). This multi-national ownership creates complex jurisdictional considerations for ground station data sovereignty.
- Telesat is Canadian-controlled via Loral and PSP Investments (a Canadian federal pension fund). It is the only Western constellation operator with significant state-adjacent institutional ownership.
- Both Chinese constellations (Guowang at 12,992 satellites and Qianfan at 14,000) are state-backed and will deploy sovereign ground infrastructure outside Western GSaaS networks. They represent a separate, parallel ground station ecosystem.
- The EU’s IRIS² is explicitly a sovereignty play — designed to reduce European dependence on Starlink. Its ground segment will be operated by Hispasat (Spanish state-owned), creating a European government-controlled ground network.

3. Ground Station as a Service Providers

GSaaS providers offer ground station access on a pay-per-use or subscription basis, allowing satellite operators to avoid the capital expenditure of building proprietary ground infrastructure. The market divides into three tiers: legacy operators with decades of heritage, VC-backed NewSpace entrants, and hyperscaler cloud platforms.

3.1 Provider Overview

Provider	Nation	Ownership / Control	Type	Sites	Antennas	Model	Funding / Rev
TIER 1: Heritage Operators (State-Backed)							
KSAT	Norway	Space Norway AS (50%) + Kongsberg Defence (50%). Both Norwegian state-controlled entities.	State	26 loc.	280+	Owned network	~$200M rev
SSC Space	Sweden	Swedish Space Corp. 100% Swedish state-owned via Ministry of Education.	State	10 owned + 11 partner	100+	Owned + partner	SEK 1.7B rev
TIER 2: VC-Backed NewSpace Operators							
Leaf Space	Italy	Private (VC-backed). Founded Politecnico di Milano. Italian-incorporated.	Private	20+ loc.	40+	Owned SDR network	$35M Series B
Skynopy	France	Private (VC-backed). French-incorporated. Paris HQ.	Private	20+ loc.	20+	Hybrid (own + lease)	$17.6M (2025)
Atlas Space Ops	USA	Private. Traverse City, MI. US-incorporated.	Private	~10 loc.	21	Cloud-native owned	Undisclosed
RBC Signals	USA	Private. Austin, TX. Acquired Microsoft Azure Orbital antenna assets 2024.	Private	30+ loc.	30+	Aggregation	Undisclosed
Infostellar	Japan	Private (VC-backed). Tokyo. Japanese-incorporated.	Private	N/A	20+ (marketplace)	Marketplace	$7.3M raised
Sfera Technologies	Bulgaria	Private. Sofia. Bulgarian-incorporated.	Private	Small	Small	HomePort platform	Undisclosed
TIER 3: Hyperscaler Cloud Platforms							
AWS Ground Stn	USA	Amazon Web Services (NASDAQ: AMZN). US-controlled.	Corporate	12 regions	N/A	Cloud-integrated	Part of AWS
Azure Orbital	USA	Microsoft (NASDAQ: MSFT). EXITED 2024 — assets sold to SLI/RBC Signals.	Exited	—	—	Exited market	N/A
TIER 4: Hybrid Operators / Integrated Players							
Viasat RTE	USA	Viasat Inc (NASDAQ: VSAT). US public company.	Public	10+ loc.	10+	High-throughput owned	Part of Viasat

3.2 Ownership and Nationality Analysis

The GSaaS market presents a clear division along national lines that has significant implications for data sovereignty, government/defence customers, and geopolitical alignment:

- Norwegian dominance at the top: KSAT, the world's largest GSaaS provider, is 100% Norwegian state-controlled through Space Norway and Kongsberg. Norway's unique geographic position (Svalbard at 78°N, Troll Antarctica at 72°S) gives it an irreplaceable polar coverage monopoly. KSAT serves NATO governments and US defence agencies. Its Hyper in-orbit relay concept will extend this dominance into space-based relay.

- Swedish state controls the #2: SSC Space, the second heritage GSaaS provider, is 100% Swedish state-owned. Between KSAT and SSC, Scandinavian government-controlled entities dominate the world's polar ground station infrastructure — critical for military, intelligence, and Earth observation missions.
- Italian/European VC leads the NewSpace tier: Leaf Space (Italian, $35M Series B) is the fastest-growing independent provider. Its SDR-based architecture allows rapid scaling without hardware lock-in. Skynopy (French, $17.6M) is the second European VC-backed challenger.
- US private sector fills the middle: Atlas, RBC Signals, and the AWS platform are US-controlled. RBC Signals absorbed Microsoft's exit from the market. Atlas has a US DoD focus. AWS Ground Station is the cloud on-ramp, not a traditional GSaaS provider.
- Japanese marketplace: Infostellar's StellarStation platform is the only significant East Asian GSaaS presence outside Chinese state systems. Its partnership with Viasat bridges the US and Japanese markets.
- Microsoft's exit is the cautionary tale: Azure Orbital launched in 2020, sold assets by 2024. Even with Azure's global data centre footprint, Microsoft concluded ground station ownership was too capital-intensive and operationally specialised. The market favours dedicated operators over generalists.

3.3 Implications for Concentric

The state ownership structures of KSAT and SSC mean that their government/defence customers already operate within a trusted national security framework. A partnership with either would position Concentric within a Five Eyes / NATO-aligned ecosystem. Leaf Space, as a VC-backed Italian company scaling rapidly into new geographies, has the most acute need for external physical security capability — it lacks the institutional state backing that KSAT and SSC enjoy. Skynopy, as a French VC-backed entrant building its own stations, is a secondary target with similar characteristics.

4. Where the Next Stations Will Be Built

Ground station deployment is driven by four factors: regulatory mandate (in-country infrastructure required for licensing), subscriber density (stations must be within ~1,000km of users for non-ISL architectures), fibre availability (backhaul to Internet exchange), and orbital coverage geometry (polar and equatorial gaps).

4.1 Africa (Highest Priority, Highest Difficulty)

Starlink operates in 20+ African countries with only 4 ground stations, all in Nigeria. This is the most under-served ground segment globally relative to subscriber growth. Kenya, South Africa, Ghana, Egypt, and Morocco are the most likely next deployment countries. OneWeb's partnership with Bayobab/Vodacom and Gulf investment in African ground infrastructure (OneWeb NEOM JV with planned East African facilities) create additional demand. Most African deployments score 3-5 on difficulty due to security environment, regulatory complexity, and infrastructure limitations. Amazon's Kuiper has Cape Town (AWS AF-South-1) as its first potential African site.

4.2 Southeast Asia (Highest Priority, Moderate Difficulty)

Vietnam was licensed in February 2026 with 4 Starlink stations planned and a 600,000 terminal target. Indonesia (270M population, archipelago geography forces multiple stations), Philippines (active but typhoon-exposed), and Thailand (licensed) represent the largest near-term opportunity. India's 1.4 billion population market is anticipated to open 2026-27 — the Indian government granted regulatory approval to Starlink as part of broader diplomatic engagement with the US administration. Both Starlink and Kuiper will require multiple ground stations per country.

4.3 Latin America (High Priority, Low-Moderate Difficulty)

Brazil (200M+ population, but Anatel regulatory friction), Mexico (130M, security concerns in some regions), Colombia, and Argentina are all growth markets. Amazon's Vrio partnership covers Latin American distribution for Kuiper. Ground station density is low relative to the subscriber opportunity.

4.4 Middle East (Moderate Priority, Low Difficulty)

UAE (OrbitWorks venture, KSAT Dubai, MBRSC), Saudi Arabia (NEOM OneWeb JV), Bahrain (AWS ME-South-1 for Kuiper), Qatar (recently approved Starlink). The Gulf states are positioning themselves as space infrastructure hubs between Asia, Africa, and Europe. Well-resourced, security-capable, but data sovereignty requirements create regulatory complexity.

4.5 Arctic and Polar (Critical Strategic Value, Maximum Difficulty)

Svalbard and Troll are effectively irreplaceable for polar TT&C. Telesat's Rankin Inlet (fly-in only, permafrost, no law enforcement) and Inuvik are the most challenging deployments in the entire register. KSAT's Hyper in-orbit relay may partially reduce polar ground dependency but will not eliminate it. The Kinuvik concept (SSC's combined Kiruna-Inuvik polar connectivity) represents the next-generation approach.

5. Traffic Volume Analysis

We estimate relative traffic volumes per site on a 1-5 scale based on subscriber density within the coverage footprint, backbone fibre capacity, number of simultaneous satellite contacts, and operator-reported capacity allocation.

Tier	Representative Sites	Traffic Driver
5 (Peak)	Redmond WA, N. Virginia, Hawthorne CA, Lagos, Tokyo, Manila, Jakarta, Mumbai, São Paulo, Ho Chi Minh City, KSAT Svalbard/Tromsø	*Constellation HQ/control centres, mega-population coverage footprints (100M+), polar TT&C concentration*
4 (High)	Goonhilly, Gravelines, Stuttgart, Fairbanks/Inuvik, Guam, Punta Arenas, Hartebeesthoek, Maricá, Puerto Rico, Abuja	*Major European gateways, polar coverage, military strategic, southern hemisphere backbone, Africa coverage*
3 (Moderate)	Most GSaaS multi-mission sites, smaller gateways, US regional E-band sites, planned/projected sites	*Standard GSaaS operations, US domestic backbone fill, new market entry pre-scaling*
2 (Low)	Remote backup sites, low-population-density coverage, early-phase GSaaS expansion	*Redundancy coverage, niche EO downlink, early commercial viability uncertain*

Critical finding: The highest-traffic sites are increasingly in developing markets (Nigeria, Philippines, Vietnam, Indonesia, India) where ground station physical security capability is weakest. This is where Concentric's differentiation is most valuable.

6. Most Difficult Deployment Environments

Deployment difficulty is assessed on a 1-5 scale incorporating political instability, contested sovereignty, regulatory hostility, physical security risk, terrain, climate, and infrastructure quality.

Difficulty 5 — Extreme

Svalbard / Troll Antarctica / Rankin Inlet: Operationally essential for polar orbit TT&C but present extreme challenges — no law enforcement, seasonal access only (Antarctica), permafrost structural risk, polar darkness for months, emergency response measured in hours. Port Harcourt, Nigeria: Niger Delta militant groups, organised crime, kidnapping. Baikonur Region, Kazakhstan: Geopolitical instability, Russian sphere, state-level threat vector.

Difficulty 4 — Very High

Lagos/Sagamu (Nigeria), Inuvik (Canada), Punta Arenas/Ushuaia (extreme Patagonia), Sanya (Chinese regulatory control), Addis Ababa (ethnic conflict, telecom monopoly), Karachi (terrorism risk). These combine high strategic value with genuine security threats or regulatory barriers.

Difficulty 3 — Elevated

Merrillan WI (dense forest concealment, severe winter), Manila (typhoon corridor), Maricá Brazil (dense informal urban), Hanoi/HCMC (state surveillance), Mumbai/Jakarta (developing-market infrastructure). Solvable with professional security design but not trivial.

7. Satellite Imagery

Concentric has acquired Copernicus Sentinel-2 true colour satellite imagery (10m resolution, L2A surface reflectance) for 29 ground station sites via the Sentinel Hub Process API (Copernicus Data Space Ecosystem). Imagery validates site isolation, security posture, and natural hazard exposure. NDVI vegetation analysis and Sentinel-1 SAR change detection capability is available via the Concentric LEO Basestation Imagery Toolkit. The imagery annex is available as a separate document.

8. Opportunity Summary

The LEO ground station market presents three entry points for Concentric, each with distinct commercial models:

Entry Point	Commercial Model	Priority Targets
Physical Security to GSaaS Providers	Per-site security assessment, ongoing monitoring, guard force and hardening services. Recurring revenue per station per year.	KSAT (26 sites, NATO/defence clients, Norwegian state-backed). Leaf Space (20+ locations, VC-backed, scaling fast). Skynopy (French, 20+ sites, expanding). All three need physical security as they enter higher-risk geographies.
Insurance Market Risk Surveys	Site-specific physical risk surveys for Lloyd's space underwriting syndicates. Fee per survey, commissioned via specialist brokers. Extends existing Concentric Lloyd's relationships.	Aon International Space Brokers (35% global premium share). Marsh Space Projects. Lead underwriters: Atrium ASIC (Syndicate 609), Hiscox London Market, AXA XL, Munich Re.
Secure Site Provision	Identify, secure, and lease hardened ground station sites in strategically valuable locations. Landlord model with security wrapper. Longer-term capital commitment but higher margin.	Amazon (300+ stations needed, regulatory mandate for in-country sites). Telesat (actively seeking GS partners). New African/Asian market entrants requiring local site partners.

The timing is optimal. Amazon must deploy half its constellation by July 2026. Starlink filed for 21 new US sites in February 2026 and entered Vietnam. Telesat is actively seeking ground station partners. The GSaaS providers are scaling faster than their physical security capability. The accompanying spreadsheet provides the complete data set across 129 sites, 16 operators, and 45+ countries.

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3.4 VC-Backed NewSpace Operator Deep Dives

The following profiles provide detailed ownership, funding, infrastructure, and expansion analysis for each VC-backed GSaaS provider. These companies represent the most dynamic and partnership-receptive segment of the market.

Leaf Space

Parameter	Detail
Legal Entity	Leaf Space S.p.A.
Incorporated	Italy (Lomazzo, Como)
Founded	2014 at Politecnico di Milano
HQ	Lomazzo (Como), Italy
US Presence	US subsidiary (established 2021)
Founders	Jonata Puglia (CEO), Giovanni Pandolfi Bortoletto (CSO), Matteo Boiocchi, Michele Messina
Employees	~50-70 (estimated 2025)
Total Funding	€35M+ equity + €15M EIB venture debt = ~€50M total capital
Latest Round	Series B, €20M (July 2023)
Lead Investors (Series B)	CDP Venture Capital (Fondo Evoluzione), Neva SGR
Other Investors	SIMEST, Digital Transition Fund (CDP group), RedSeed Ventures, Primo Space (Primomiglio SGR), Whysol Investments, European Investment Bank (debt)
Revenue Growth	3x year-over-year since 2020 (company-reported)
Satellites Supported	140+ (2025)
Monthly Passes	24,000+ (2025)
Stations	40+ antennas across 20+ locations
Ownership Nationality	Italian. Investors are predominantly Italian institutional (CDP is Italian state development bank subsidiary, Neva is Intesa Sanpaolo banking group).

Current Ground Station Locations: Graz (Austria), Viterbo (Italy), Azores (Portugal), Hartebeesthoek (South Africa), Hokkaido (Japan), Alice Springs (Australia), Sri Lanka, Santiago (Chile), Reykjavik (Iceland), Bulgaria (2025), Canada (2025 expansion). 18 new stations planned through 2026 in high-demand regions.

Expansion Plan: Adding 18 stations by end-2026. Targeting Ka-band for remote sensing, larger aperture antennas for GEO, optical ground systems, and cislunar solutions. New Leaf Key (dedicated stations) and Leaf Hosting (customer equipment on Leaf sites) services launched 2025.

Concentric Assessment: *Leaf Space is the strongest partnership target for Concentric. VC-backed with no state security apparatus. Scaling into higher-risk geographies (Africa, South Asia) where physical security is the primary capability gap. Italian ownership with Italian state development capital backing creates a clean jurisdictional profile for Five Eyes / NATO-adjacent work. CYSEC cybersecurity partnership (Swiss) shows awareness of security needs. The Leaf Hosting model — where customers deploy their own equipment on Leaf sites — creates a natural role for Concentric as the physical security provider for hosted infrastructure.*

Skynopy

Parameter	Detail
Legal Entity	Skynopy SAS
Incorporated	France (Paris)
Founded	October 2023
HQ	Paris, France
Founders	Pierre Bertrand (CEO, ex-Loft Orbital, MIT), Antonin Hirsch (CTO, ex-Loft Orbital)
Employees	~15 (PitchBook 2025)
Total Funding	~€18M (~$21M)
Latest Round	Seed/Series A, €15M (June 2025). Closed in under one month.
Lead Investor	Alven Capital Partners (French VC)
Other Investors	Expansion Venture Capital, Omnes Capital, CNES (SpaceFounders programme), Heartcore Capital, BPI France, Kima Ventures
Revenue	Pre-revenue / early commercial (estimated)
Stations	15+ antennas (mid-2025), targeting 100+ by 2028
Ownership Nationality	French. CNES (French space agency) is a strategic investor via SpaceFounders. French government has policy interest in sovereign ground infrastructure.

Current Ground Station Locations: Hybrid model — leases spare capacity from constellation operators (leveraging unused Starlink/OneWeb antennas) plus building own sites. Confirmed own-build: Saint-Pierre et Miquelon (French territory, near Newfoundland) and Réunion (French territory, Indian Ocean). Orange named as a partner.

Expansion Plan: AKAR project: unified high-speed real-time space network planned for 2028. Target 100+ antennas within 3 years via ‘massive agreement’ with unnamed major industry partner. Focus on S, X, and Ka-band high-throughput for EO constellations.

Concentric Assessment: *Skynopy is the fastest-growing entrant. Founded 18 months ago, already has 15+ stations and €18M in funding. The French government (via CNES and BPI France) has strategic interest in sovereign ground infrastructure, which aligns with Concentric’s government/defence positioning. Building own stations in French overseas territories (Saint-Pierre, Réunion) creates immediate site security requirements. The hybrid model of leasing spare constellation capacity is innovative but creates complex site access arrangements that would benefit from professional security management.*

Atlas Space Operations

Parameter	Detail
Legal Entity	ATLAS Space Operations, Inc.
Incorporated	United States (Delaware)
Founded	2015 (California, moved to Michigan 2017)
HQ	Traverse City, Michigan, USA
Other Offices	Colorado Springs, CO
CEO	John Williams (former Viasat executive)
Employees	~30-50 (estimated)
Total Funding	$15M+ (growth round Sept 2024)
Lead Investor	NewSpace Capital (Luxembourg-based space PE)
Other Investors	Michigan Capital Network, Beringea, Wakestream Ventures, Boomerang Catapult, Michigan Rise, Red Cedar Ventures
Stations	50+ antennas across 34+ ground stations in 20+ countries
Key Platform	Freedom® Software — cloud-native, single API, federated network-of-networks
Key Clients	US Space Force (FORGE C2 programme), Viasat/NASA, HawkEye 360
Acquisition	York Space Systems (US defence tech) agreed to acquire Atlas, July 2025. Pending FCC approval.
Ownership Nationality	US-owned. Post-acquisition will be part of York Space Systems (US defence). Strong US DoD/IC alignment.

Current Ground Station Locations: Federated network across 34+ locations globally including Traverse City MI (HQ), Finland (Muonio, NorthBase partnership), Mingenew Australia, Awarua New Zealand, American Samoa (construction started March 2026), Rwanda. Freedom software integrates partner antennas into unified network.

Expansion Plan: EMEA expansion strategy (Europe, Middle East, Africa). Lunar orbit antenna capability under development. Post-York acquisition will integrate into Golden Dome defence architecture. 100% contract renewal rate demonstrates sticky customer base.

Concentric Assessment: *Atlas is being acquired by York Space Systems, a US defence company. Post-acquisition, it becomes part of a US military-industrial ecosystem where Concentric's government security credentials are directly relevant. The Freedom software platform's strength is network federation — connecting disparate partner antennas into one system. This means Atlas operates across sites it doesn't own, creating a complex multi-party physical security challenge. The American Samoa and Rwanda expansions into challenging geographies create near-term security requirements.*

RBC Signals

Parameter	Detail
Legal Entity	RBC Signals Inc.
Incorporated	United States
Founded	2015
HQ	Redmond, WA (previously Austin, TX)
Founders	Christopher Richins (CEO), Olga Gershenzon
Employees	1-10 (Tracxn 2024)
Total Funding	$3.2M (seed rounds)
Investors	Bee Partners, Freerun Ventures, Morgan Brook Capital, Dcode, Abstract Ventures
Key Asset Acquisition	Microsoft Azure Orbital ground station assets (10 x 6m S/X band tracking antennas), completed March 2025 via Space Leasing International
Stations	30+ (aggregated from partner ground station owners)
Business Model	Capacity aggregation / marketplace. Monetises unused capacity from existing ground station owners under revenue-sharing.
Ownership Nationality	US-owned. Small team, bootstrapped growth model augmented by Microsoft asset acquisition.

Concentric Assessment: *RBC Signals is the scrappiest player in the market. Very lean team, modest funding, but strategically acquired Microsoft's physical ground station assets when the hyperscaler exited. The aggregation model means RBC doesn't own most of its network — it brokers spare capacity. This limits the physical security partnership opportunity compared to operators who own their infrastructure. However, the Microsoft antenna assets are now RBC-owned and may require site security services. Partnership with mu Space for Thailand site shows expansion into Southeast Asia.*

Infostellar

Parameter	Detail
Legal Entity	Infostellar Inc.
Incorporated	Japan (Tokyo)
Founded	2016
HQ	Tokyo, Japan
Founders	Naomi Kurahara (CEO), Kazuo Ishigame
Employees	11-50 (Tracxn 2024)
Total Funding	$21.3M across 4 rounds
Latest Round	Series B, $4.3M (January 2022)
Key Investors	ITOCHU Corporation, Mitsubishi UFJ Capital, Mitsubishi Corporation, Mizuho Capital, Airbus Ventures, Sony Innovation Fund, Pavilion Capital Partners
Stations	28+ (StellarStation marketplace network)
Owned Infrastructure	Taiki teleport (Hokkaido, Japan). Expanding to Central/Southern Japan.
Key Partnership	Viasat RTE — mutual distribution agreement since 2020. Viasat RTE station co-located at Infostellar’s Hokkaido site.
Ownership Nationality	Japanese. Investors are major Japanese industrial conglomerates (ITOCHU, Mitsubishi, Mizuho) plus Airbus Ventures (European). Deep Japanese institutional backing.

Concentric Assessment: *Infostellar is a marketplace model (like Airbnb for ground stations) rather than an infrastructure owner. Its StellarStation platform connects satellite operators with antenna owners who have spare capacity. This limits direct physical security partnership opportunity. However, the Japanese institutional investor base (ITOCHU, Mitsubishi, Mizuho) represents significant corporate relationships that could open doors for broader security mandates. The Viasat co-location in Hokkaido is a concrete infrastructure asset. NorthBase partnership in Finland extends into Nordic territory.*

Sfera Technologies

Parameter	Detail
Legal Entity	Sfera Technologies Ltd.
Incorporated	Bulgaria (Sofia)
Founded	2019
HQ	Sofia, Bulgaria
Platform	HomePort — integrated ground segment service with privacy-oriented storage and processing
Funding	Undisclosed (early stage)
Stations	Small, own-operated (Bulgaria)
Ownership Nationality	Bulgarian. EU member state. Early stage, limited public information on investors.

Concentric Assessment: *Too early stage for immediate partnership. Monitor as a potential acquisition target for larger GSaaS players. Privacy-oriented architecture (HomePort) is a differentiator that may attract government/defence customers.*

Appendix A: Potential Real Estate Sites for Future Ground Stations

The following locations are assessed as high-probability sites for future LEO ground station deployment based on coverage gap analysis, regulatory trajectory, fibre backbone availability, and population density drivers. These represent potential real estate acquisition or leasing opportunities for a ground station hosting business.

Priority	Location	Country	Rationale	Fibre Access	Terrain	Difficulty
1	Mombasa / Malindi	Kenya	East African gateway. Undersea cable landing (TEAMS, EASSy, LION2). Starlink licensed. Only existing GS infrastructure is Malindi ESA tracking station.	Excellent (cable landing)	Coastal tropical	3
2	Accra / Tema	Ghana	West African coverage gap. Undersea cables (ACE, WACS, MainOne). Stable governance. Starlink licensed.	Good (cable landing)	Coastal tropical	2
3	Muscat / Duqm	Oman	Etlaq Spaceport under construction in Duqm (2027). Strategic position between Asia/Africa/Europe. Clean regulatory environment.	Good	Desert coastal	2
4	Tashkent area	Uzbekistan	Central Asian coverage gap. Reforming economy. China BRI connectivity. Minimal existing ground infrastructure.	Developing	Continental steppe	3
5	Surabaya / Bali	Indonesia	Eastern Indonesia coverage. 270M population. Archipelago forces multiple stations. Starlink licensed.	Good (Java backbone)	Tropical volcanic	3

6	Pune / Hyderabad	India	1.4B population. Tech hub infrastructure. Starlink/Kuiper regulatory entry expected 2026-27. AWS region nearby.	Excellent	Plateau, moderate	2
7	Dakar	Senegal	Francophone West Africa gateway. Undersea cable landing. Stable governance. French GSaaS operators (Skynopy) have strategic interest.	Good (cable landing)	Coastal semi-arid	3
8	Antananarivo area	Madagascar	Indian Ocean coverage gap. Between Africa and Asia. Réunion (French) nearby.	Limited	Tropical highland	4
9	Medellín area	Colombia	Andean coverage. Growing tech hub. AWS Bogotá local zone nearby. Lower security risk than other Colombian regions.	Good	Mountain valley	2
10	Thessaloniki	Greece	Eastern Mediterranean coverage. EU member. Low cost. Good fibre via submarine cables. KSAT Athens nearby but this extends coverage east.	Good	Coastal Mediterranean	1
11	Perth suburbs	Australia	Western Australian coverage complement to Geraldton. AWS AP-Southeast-2 region. Strong fibre backbone.	Excellent	Coastal temperate	1
12	Nouméa	New Caledonia (FR)	South Pacific coverage gap. French territory (sovereign advantage for	Good (cable)	Tropical island	3

			Skynopy/CNES). Undersea cable (Gondwana-2).			
13	Djibouti	Djibouti	Strategic Horn of Africa. Military base concentration (US, France, China, Japan). Multiple submarine cable landings. Extreme heat.	Excellent (cables)	Desert coastal	3
14	Tánger area	Morocco	North African gateway. OneWeb regulatory approval anticipated 2025. EU-adjacent. Gibraltar Strait strategic position.	Good (submarine cables)	Mediterranean coastal	2
15	Ulaanbaatar area	Mongolia	Central/East Asian coverage gap. Between Russian and Chinese infrastructure. Sparse population but growing connectivity demand.	Developing	Continental steppe	4

Site selection criteria: (1) Coverage gap in current constellation ground networks, (2) Regulatory environment permitting foreign ground station operation, (3) Proximity to existing fibre backbone or submarine cable landing, (4) Population density within 1,000km radius, (5) Availability of suitable land (flat, low RFI, adequate power supply), (6) Political stability and physical security environment.

Appendix B: VC-Backed GSaaS Provider Financial Summary

The following table summarises publicly available financial data for the VC-backed GSaaS providers profiled in Section 3.4. All figures are from company announcements, press coverage, and investor databases (Tracxn, PitchBook, Crunchbase). Revenue figures are estimates where not publicly disclosed. All figures in USD unless otherwise stated.

Company	Total Raised	Latest Round	Date	Lead Investor	Valuation (est)	Revenue Status	Burn Rate Indicator
Leaf Space	$32.7M equity + $16.5M EIB debt	Series B, €20M	Jul 2023	CDP Venture Capital / Neva SGR	Not disclosed (~$80-120M est)	Revenue-generating. 3x YoY growth since 2020.	Moderate. EIB debt suggests sustainable model.
Skynopy	~$21M (€18M)	Seed/Series A, €15M	Jun 2025	Alven Capital Partners	Not disclosed (~$40-60M est)	Early commercial. Strategic clients onboarding.	High. 15 employees, rapid hiring planned.
Atlas Space Ops	$15M (growth round)	Growth, $15M	Sep 2024	NewSpace Capital	Not disclosed	Revenue-generating. 100% contract renewal.	Moderate. 34+ stations, govt contracts.
RBC Signals	$3.2M (seed)	Seed	Apr 2021	Bee Partners	Not disclosed	Early revenue. Asset-light model.	Low. <10 employees, aggregation model.
Infostellar	$21.3M	Series B, $4.3M	Jan 2022	Pavilion Capital Partners	Not disclosed	Pre-profit. ~500 passes/month.	Moderate. 11-50 employees. Japanese institutional backers provide runway.
Sfera Tech	Undisclosed	Early stage	N/A	N/A	Not disclosed	Pre-revenue (estimated)	Low. Small team.

Investor Nationality Map

Understanding investor nationality is critical for assessing alignment with Concentric’s government and defence client base:

Company	Primary Investor Nationality	Government/State Capital	Strategic Implications
Leaf Space	Italian	Yes — CDP (Italian state development bank), SIMEST (Italian trade promotion), EIB (EU institution)	Italian state has strategic interest. EU institutional backing. Clean for NATO/Five Eyes adjacent work.
Skynopy	French	Yes — CNES (French space agency), BPI France (French state investment bank)	French sovereign ground infrastructure agenda. Overseas territory expansion (Saint-Pierre, Réunion) is government-supported.
Atlas Space Ops	US / Luxembourg	No direct state capital. But York acquisition (US defence) changes this.	Post-acquisition: US defence ecosystem. Direct DoD/IC alignment.
RBC Signals	US	US DoD connection (Dcode	Lean, bootstrapped.

		accelerator participation).	Microsoft asset deal shows opportunistic growth.
Infostellar	Japanese	No direct state capital. But ITOCHU, Mitsubishi, Mizuho are quasi-institutional Japanese keiretsu.	Japanese corporate backing provides stability. Airbus Ventures adds European connection.
Sfera Tech	Bulgarian	None known.	EU member state. Early stage.

Key M&A Activity (2024-2026)

Date	Transaction	Value	Significance
Oct 2024	Eutelsat sells ground station assets to EQT	€790M ($830M)	1,400 antennas across 100+ locations. Largest ground segment transaction. Establishes infrastructure-as-investment-asset class.
Oct 2024	Microsoft sells Azure Orbital assets to SLI	Not disclosed	Hyperscaler exits direct GSaaS. Assets transferred to RBC Signals. Validates dedicated operator model over generalist.
Jul 2025	York Space Systems acquires Atlas Space Ops	Not disclosed	US defence company acquires largest US-owned GSaaS provider. Pending FCC approval. Integration into Golden Dome architecture.
Feb 2026	KSAT announces Hyper in-orbit relay	N/A	Orbiting ground stations. Extends KSAT’s polar dominance into space-based relay. Potential game-changer for latency-critical EO.

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